HAIMING (RICHARD) LI

Department of Economics
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Business and Economics — Lehigh University — Expected May 2027

Dissertation: "Three Essays in Health Economics"

Committee: Chad D. Meyerhoefer (Chair), Jee-Hun Choi, Yulong Wang, Bingjin Xue

M.S. Applied Economics and Econometrics — University of Southern California — 2022

B.S. Business Administration — Beijing Institute of Technology — 2019

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Health Economics

Secondary: Applied Econometrics; Industrial Organization

Teaching Interests: Principles of Economics; Intermediate Microeconomics; Econometrics and Statistics (Python, R, Stata); Health Economics and Health Policy; Introduction to Finance

RESEARCH

JOB MARKET PAPER

Haiming Li. "Cross-Border Spillovers of Recreational Cannabis Legalization on Mental Health: Evidence from Pennsylvania." ***Preparing for Submission*** · Latest version

I estimate how New Jersey's 2021 recreational cannabis legalization affected psychiatric hospitalizations across the state border in Pennsylvania, which permits only medical use. Combining ZIP code-quarter inpatient discharge records for 2018–2022 with driving times to New Jersey dispensaries, I compare matched ZIP codes in counties near and far from those dispensaries before and after legalization. Psychiatric hospitalizations near the border rose by 0.83 per 1,000 residents per quarter, or 6.8 percent, led by depression and followed by alcohol- and tobacco-related disorders, dementia and other organic disorders, and psychosis. Hospitalizations coded to cannabis use itself did not change. Evaluations of legalization that stop at the state line omit this cost.

WORKING PAPERS

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. "Fueling Out of Work: Vehicle Market Restructuring and Labor Supply among Car-Dependent Workers." ***Revise and Resubmit***

We study whether fuel-economy regulation affects labor supply by reshaping vehicle markets. The 2011 CAFE footprint reform made standards less stringent for larger vehicles, shifting production away from compact cars and reducing the supply of entry-level vehicles. Using CPS ASEC data for 2001–2019 and a rural–urban difference-in-differences design, we find that rural labor force participation and employment fell by about 0.9 and 1.0 percentage points, with larger declines among low- and middle-income adults. Employed rural workers moved to longer hours and full-time work, consistent with higher fixed costs of working for car-dependent households.

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Placebo Tests for Policy Order: A Cautionary Note from Vaping Bans and Cannabis Legalization.” ***Preparing for Submission***

Studies of whether the order of two staggered policies matters often use a fake-timing placebo that reshuffles one policy’s dates. We show that the reshuffle leaves many states’ order unchanged, so the placebo distribution is not centered at zero; recentering it restores the test’s power. In an application to indoor vaping bans and cannabis legalization, an ordering effect on adult e-cigarette use passes the recentered test but fails pre-trend and leave-one-out checks.

Chad D. Meyerhoefer, Haiming Li, Erin Ware, John Moeller, Haiyan Chen, Jessica Faul, and Richard Manski. “The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease: A GWAS-by-Subtraction Genomic Structural Equation Instrumental Variables Model.” Supported by NIH/NIDCR R03DE034043. ***Preparing for Submission***

We estimate the causal effect of edentulism on heart disease using genetic data in the 2006–2020 Health and Retirement Study. A GWAS-by-subtraction structural equation model yields a polygenic score for poor oral health that excludes genetic variants with direct effects on heart disease. Edentulism raises the likelihood of a heart disease diagnosis by 48 percentage points and of a heart attack in the past two years by 3.9 to 6.9 percentage points, with larger effects for men. Cost estimates of a Medicare dental benefit that leave out these offsets may be too high.

Haiming Li. “Do State Psychiatric Hospital Closures Increase Length of Stay in Acute Care Hospitals? Evidence from Pennsylvania.” ***Draft Available***

I study four closures of Pennsylvania state psychiatric hospitals between 2006 and 2019, using all inpatient discharge records and difference-in-differences with permutation inference. After the Harrisburg closure, inpatient days per patient with a psychotic disorder rose by 8.8 per year, about half the baseline, while admissions did not change; after the Allentown closure they rose by 4.3. The added days came from stays longer than 90 days in county-funded long-stay units, and nine tenths of the added Harrisburg days were billed to Medicaid and Medicare. The other two closures show no detectable change.

Haiming Li and Chad D. Meyerhoefer. “Does Dental Coverage Reduce the Financial Burden of Heart Disease?” ***Draft in Preparation***

Using the Health and Retirement Study for 2006–2020, we instrument total tooth loss with a polygenic score for dental caries that excludes genetic variants with direct effects on heart disease. Tooth loss raises the probability of any out-of-pocket spending on heart disease by about 39 percentage points, or about $500 per two years under an incremental-cost measure, but does not raise catastrophic health spending.

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Policy Spillovers Across Substances: E-Cigarette Regulation, Cannabis Legalization, and Health Outcomes.” ***Draft in Preparation***

WORK IN PROGRESS

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “Do Foreign Policies Save American Lives? Evidence from China’s Fentanyl Control.” ***Analysis in Progress***

Haiming Li and Yizhao Wang. “E-Cigarette Regulation, Recreational Cannabis Legalization, and College Outcomes: Evidence from New York State.” ***Analysis in Progress***

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston, TX *(scheduled)*
Job market paper

2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA *(scheduled)*
Job market paper

2026 American College of Medical Genetics Annual Clinical Genetics Meeting, Baltimore, MD *(poster)*
The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease

2026 ASSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA *(presented by coauthor)*
The Causal Effect of Poor Oral Health on Heart Disease

2025 New York State Economics Association Annual Conference, Rochester, NY
Policy Spillovers Across Substances

2023 Pennsylvania Economic Association Annual Conference, Washington, PA
Optimizing Product Protection Plan Premiums

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Research Assistant to Chad D. Meyerhoefer, NIH/NIDCR Grant R03DE034043 — Summers 2025, 2026

Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Lehigh University — 2025–2026

TEACHING

LEHIGH UNIVERSITY

ECO 301/403	Econometric Software	**Adjunct Professor**	Spring 2027 *(scheduled)*
ECO 146	Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis	**Adjunct Professor**	Summer 2026
ECO 001	Principles of Economics	Teaching Assistant	2022–2024; Fall 2026
ECO 045	Statistical Methods	Teaching Assistant	January 2026
FIN 125	Introduction to Finance	Teaching Assistant	2024–2025

MORAVIAN UNIVERSITY

HHUM 125	Introduction to Health Humanities	Guest Lecturer	February 2026

TEACHING AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Effective Teaching Practices, Association of College and University Educators (ACUE) — In progress

Strategic Methods for AI-Responsive Teaching (SMART), Lehigh University — Fall 2026

SERVICE

REFEREE SERVICE

Journal of Mental Health Policy and Economics — 2026

UNIVERSITY SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Graduate Orientation Ambassador, College of Business, Lehigh University — 2025, 2026

President, Lehigh University Chinese Christian Fellowship — 2023–present

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Deacon and Pianist, Lehigh Valley Chinese Christian Church, Bethlehem, PA 2022–present

SKILLS

Computing: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, Mathematica, SQL, LaTeX, ArcGIS, Tableau

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic)

Others: Piano, violin, guitar, and trumpet; tennis

REFERENCES

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